

The Mantra That Dispels Illnesses of Bile

Toh 800 · Derge Kangyur

མཁན་པའི་ནད་སེལ་བའི་སྒྲུག་

The Mantra That Dispels Illnesses of Bile is a very short text, and the Tibetan title line names it as "the mantra that dispels illnesses of bile" (mkhris pa'i nad sel ba'i sngags); the Sanskrit title is not evident from the material at hand. It is a protective incantation of the dhāraṇī type, offering a brief spoken remedy for ailments traditionally attributed to bile, such as yellowing of the eyes, nausea, and vomiting. After a homage to the Three Jewels and the mantra itself, the text prescribes reciting it while fanning the body with a cooling fan, and it closes with a note on a companion dhāraṇī for pacifying the stinging pain of burns from fire. It is Toh 800 in the Kangyur, belonging to the class of dhāraṇī texts within the Tantra division, where short spells for healing and protection are gathered.

Recite it eleven times and anoint the spittle upon the affected place, and the stinging pain of a burn caused by fire is pacified. Here ends the dhāraṇī that thoroughly pacifies the stinging pain of fire.

The mantra that dispels illnesses of bile.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namo hetu hege svāhā.

If one fans the body with a cooling fan while reciting it, it dispels illnesses of bile, yellow eyes, and the sickness of nausea and vomiting. Here ends the dhāraṇī that dispels illnesses of bile.

Translator's Notes

- The opening lines are the ending of the preceding dhāraṇī, which is why the instruction begins mid-rite. The mantra syllables are transliterated as given and are likely corrupt, so I have not tried to reconstruct them. The term for the illness following "yellow eyes" is uncertain; I have taken it as a disorder of nausea or retching, but it could instead refer to a related bilious disorder. The rite appears to be a brief ritual-medical formula, and the instruction to fan the body while reciting is likely a standard accompanying gesture.

Colophon

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human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.